

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

ethan@staffroomai.com | (512) 694-4844 | GitHub

August 6, 2026

Dear Taskrabbit hiring team,

I am writing about the AI Solutions Lead role in San Francisco. For three years I have been the only technical person on my own engagements: I embed with a client's operating team, map how the work actually happens, build the automation, and stay until they can run and extend it without me. That is the loop your posting describes. I live in Emeryville, so Tuesdays and Wednesdays on Sutter Street are a short commute.

Taskrabbit's product is putting a person into the work. That makes the internal version of the same question sharper here than at most companies: which parts of your teams' days are genuinely repetitive, and which only look that way from a dashboard. I build so the person stays the decision-maker. With 450 employees behind a marketplace running in nine countries, the leverage is in automations that travel between functions, and I would rather set that pattern early in an AI for Work function than retrofit it later.

How that maps to what you need:

- Building with Claude: agents and automations in production since 2023 using the Claude API, tool-calling, MCP servers, and Claude Code as a daily driver. Shipped systems non-technical teams use, not demos.
- Discovery into enablement: I automated an IT MSP's pre-sales risk assessments, cut processing time 98%, then trained their team to keep changing it as their process changed.
- Measurement first: I set the baseline before I build. One ingestion pipeline went 99.8% higher in throughput in four months at 86% lower cost.
- Skeptical stakeholders: at IBM I embedded with a customer-support team and ran Design Thinking sessions with the engineers whose queue I was about to change, then shipped DRE Bot, a Watson NLP Slack app that cut their most common issues to a single response. They kept using it because they had shaped it.

The two-sided dynamics between Taskers and clients would be new to me, and I would rather say that plainly than pretend otherwise. What I have done most often is this job's harder part: walk into an operation I did not grow up in, get fluent enough to be useful within weeks, and earn the trust of the people whose process I am about to change.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome the chance to talk about which functions you are looking at first.

Sincerely,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker